

DC Site Intelligence

NexPhase Advisory

Across 20 priority US data-center markets, **California** leads NexPhase's Site Intelligence ranking at **8.5/10**, on the deepest interconnection pipeline in the set. **Arizona** and **Oregon** follow. 8 of the 20 markets sit in the underdeveloped tier — where grid infrastructure is ahead of current DC build-out.

RANKED MARKETS — TOP 10

#	State	Score	Saturation	STRONG	Load Growth
1	CA California	8.5	Underdeveloped	22	-2.4%
2	AZ Arizona	6.5	Saturated	8	+2.2%
3	OR Oregon	5.9	Saturated	5	+3.4%
4	WA Washington	5.3	Underdeveloped	1	-1.7%
5	NV Nevada	5.1	Emerging	1	-2.8%
6	FL Florida	5.0	Underdeveloped	3	+0.9%
7	CO Colorado	4.7	Underdeveloped	1	-2.1%
8	TN Tennessee	4.3	Emerging	0	-2.9%
9	OH Ohio	4.2	Saturated	1	+0.9%
10	IL Illinois	4.1	Underdeveloped	2	-2.2%

TOP 3 MARKETS

California #1 · 8.5/10

California ranks #1 at 8.5/10, carried by 22 substations rated STRONG for infrastructure density (avg 5.31/10 across 131 queue substations). As open runway — interconnection infrastructure ahead of current DC build-out (underdeveloped tier), load growth is soft (-2.4% weighted), so the case rests on grid capacity rather than demand momentum.

Arizona #2 · 6.5/10

Arizona ranks #2 at 6.5/10, carried by 8 substations rated STRONG for infrastructure density (avg 4.95/10 across 194 queue substations). As a built-out, competitive market (saturated tier), utility load is growing (+2.2% weighted).

Oregon #3 · 5.9/10

Oregon ranks #3 at 5.9/10, carried by 5 substations rated STRONG for infrastructure density (avg 4.48/10 across 213 queue substations). As a built-out, competitive market (saturated tier), utility load is growing (+3.4% weighted).

METHODOLOGY

Each market is scored 1–10 from four factors; the three continuous factors are min-max normalized across the 20 states, then weighted:

- **Avg Infrastructure Density (35%)** — mean transmission-infrastructure density of the state's interconnection-queue substations.
- **STRONG Substation Count (25%)** — substations rated STRONG (deep, active queue + high voltage).
- **Weighted Load Growth (25%)** — utility retail-sales YoY growth, weighted by load; excludes non-organic reporting outliers.
- **Saturation Tier (15%)** — DC build-out maturity (underdeveloped > emerging > saturated).

Chris Santiago · NexPhase Advisory

20+ years power origination & interconnection · NextEra alumni · 5+ GW to NTP · FERC Order 1000 wins

Compiled from publicly available sources — ISO/RTO interconnection queue data, EIA-860 & EIA-861 surveys, and utility commission records. Analysis reflects the author's independent professional assessment. Scores refresh weekly.